

Un-essay Assignment Guidelines

The goal of this assignment is to create something that would help a lay-person to understand how cognitive psychology can be applicable to real life. You are asked to focus on one or two specific topics we have covered instead of approaching cognitive psychology from a broad perspective. Some example topics are learning strategies for university students, myths and facts about multitasking and attention, explanations of sensory illusions, tips for learning a new language, etc.

Your creation can follow any format that you prefer. For example, you can create an infographic, a little story, a short film, a TikTok video, a comic, a podcast episode, a children's book, a script for a play, or anything else you can think of. Although the nature of this assignment is rather unconstrained, there are some guidelines to follow.

- Your creation should be **accurate** in content. It is expected that you deliver the constructs you discuss in a clear manner that includes relevant details. The un-essay should be clearly based on cognitive psychology.
- Your story should be **compelling**. You should present the information truthfully and in an interesting manner.
- You should present the information **effectively**. Your un-essay should be readable/watchable/listenable and well-constructed (which involves proof-reading, editing, and polishing). Your target audience is the general public, so make sure your language is accessible.
- I prefer if you submit this assignment electronically (via email). If you wish to create something non-electronically, communicate this with me first so we can create an arrangement for how you can deliver your assignment. If you choose to submit electronically, you can also share your assignment with the class! I will make a portal available on URCourses.
- Since this is a big class, your creation must be consumed for no longer than 10 minutes. In other words, an audio recording or a video should be less than about 10 minutes, or a story/book should be read in about a maximum of 10 minutes. Failure to do so may result in a grade reduction.
- If your project is limited in verbal information (e.g., painting), you may include a snippet of writing as a supplement to improve clarity. I recommend staying true to the format you choose. If you wish to do a painting, for example, I recommend painting a visual phenomenon.
- **The entirety of your work must be your own. Although you are allowed to brainstorm with others (including AI tools), the final form of the assignment must be your own creation. Failure to do so is academic misconduct and the matters will be taken to the appropriate Dean.**

Don't let the unrestrained nature of this assignment intimidate you! Try to have fun, be creative, and critically think about how you can help someone apply cognitive psychology to their daily life. Here's a rubric to help you further understand the *guidelines* I will be using for evaluating your work on the second page:

Criteria	25 marks	20 marks	15 marks	≤ 10 marks
Clarity	The cognitive psychology construct is clear and obvious. There is no room for guessing for the consumer of the content.	Slight improvements could be made in clarity, but the construct is otherwise obvious. There is little room for guessing for the consumer of the content.	The cognitive psychology construct is somewhat clear. There are minor ambiguities that leaves room for guessing.	The construct is not clear or inaccurately labeled. The consumer of the content would need to go out of their way to identify it.
Accuracy	The principle or construct is presented accurately without technical error. Information is detailed. It provides the audience with a complete and thorough representation of the construct.	The principle or construct is presented mostly accurately with minor technical error. Information is detailed. It provides the audience with a mostly complete and thorough representation of the construct.	The principle or construct is presented somewhat accurately with notable technical error. Information could be further detailed. It provides the audience with a preliminary representation of the construct.	The principle or construct is presented inaccurately with notable technical error. Information is overly brief. It does not provide the audience with an accurate representation of the construct.
Compelling Story	Construct is presented in a way that is interesting and accessible to the general public. It provides a complete story and is clearly connected to daily life.	Construct is presented in a way that is interesting and somewhat accessible to the general public. It provides a mostly complete story and is connected to daily life.	Construct is presented in a way that notably inaccessible to the general public. The connection of the construct to daily life is somewhat unclear.	Construct is presented in a way that is inaccessible to the general public. It does not make connections to daily life.
Effective Communication	Project is presentable without technical issues. Project delivery is well thought-out. Project is clearly proofread, edited, and polished in presentation.	Project is presentable with minor technical issues. Project delivery is mostly well thought-out. Project is proofread, edited, and polished in presentation with minor errors.	Project is presentable with some technical issues. Project delivery is not well thought-out. Project has numerous errors in editing and polishing.	Project is not presentable due to technical issues. Project delivery is not well thought-out. There are numerous significant errors.